LEAD DATA ENGINEER · CHIEF DATA OFFICE · QUILTER

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I lead data platforms on Databricks within Azure, and I work with the business as closely as with the code: every conversation with a department ends in a data contract that compiles into tests. London · firman.insan.m@gmail.com · right to work in the UK, no sponsorship required.

What I delivered at Lifepal, with how it was measured

6h → 90m
Nightly batch window. Median of 30 runs either side of the change.

99.7%
Less reporting latency: 24 h to under 5 min, on Kafka and Debezium CDC.

$11k
Monthly platform cost against a $19k projection, held for four quarters.

−60%
Ad-hoc report requests (214 → 86 a quarter); trust escalations fell by the same share.

512
Automated quality assertions across 47 sources in CI/CD. DQ ≥ 0.98.

How I work: what the role asks, what I've done, and a chapter you can open

THE ROLE ASKS FOR	WHAT I HAVE DONE	HOW I WORK
Technical leadership	Primary engineering authority across Finance, Actuarial, Marketing and Product. I lead design, review code and architecture, and record decisions as ADRs.	**1 Design it**
Engineering delivery	Batch and streaming on Databricks within Azure; Terraform, Azure DevOps and GitLab CI/CD; zero manual changes in production.	**2 Ship it**
Mentoring	Line manage 3–5 engineers; two promoted to senior; onboarding four weeks to two; 100+ engineers taught at Hacktiv8.	**3 Grow the team**
Cross-functional	Finance, Marketing, HR, Executive and Product own their definitions, agreed in writing before any code.	**4 Work with the business**
Operational excellence	Freshness SLOs with breach alerting, anomaly detection, and root-cause analysis that ends in a durable fix.	**5 Keep it running**
Regulatory	Masking, row-level access, lineage and retention for GDPR and audit. Consumer Duty outcomes as certified products.	**6 Protect clients**
Batch and real-time	Kafka and Debezium CDC into Delta with idempotent MERGE; batch for certified numbers.	**7 Keep it live**

How I work with the business

- **No surprises.** Owners hear bad news from me first, in writing, with a time for the next update.
- **Start from the decision.** Point to a certified measure before building anything new.
- **Contract first, report second.** Definitions, owners, grants and tests live in YAML.
- **First Light under pressure.** Ship the smallest truth that helps today's decision, keep it reversible, name the debt, protect the team's focus.

My first 90 days

- **Days 1–30:** learn the domain from its owners and its data; build a record of what exists, what it feeds and who owns it. Change nothing.
- **Days 31–60:** own the highest-traffic products: run them, fix them, join their incident rota, and write contracts for the rules that live in someone's head.
- **Days 61–90:** agree one ingestion pattern, one quality mechanism and one deployment path with the other leads, adopted where each has proved itself twice.

The foundation: the lakehouse. Every chapter runs on the Delta tables my Databricks Python built, in the browser, with the same grants and masks: **rfim.github.io/nexus-quilter/simulate.html** · code: **github.com/rfim/nexus-quilter**

Depth, honestly. In production: Databricks within Azure, Delta on ADLS Gen2, Workflows, ADF, Key Vault, Spark tuning, Kafka and Debezium CDC. Unity Catalog, Asset Bundles and Lakeflow at working level; Data Vault and Fabric at concept level.